

“WE STUDY THE GLORY OF GOD, AND THE HONOUR AND LIBERTY OF PARLIAMENT, FOR WHICH WE... FIGHT, WITHOUT SEEKING OUR OWN INTERESTS...”

Oliver Cromwell, English Parliamentarian general, Battle of Marston Moor, 1644

ON APRIL 24, 1644, AS A REBEL MING ARMY under Li Zicheng prepared to take Beijing, the Chongzhen Emperor, the last Ming ruler, committed suicide. In February, Li had proclaimed the Shun dynasty, but it was not to last long. In May, the Manchus, allying with a remnant Ming force, crushed Li's army at the Battle of Shanhai Pass. By the autumn, the first Manchu Qing emperor of China, the six-year-old Shunzhi Emperor (1638–61), had been installed in Beijing. Ming resistance in the south continued until 1681. The Qing themselves ruled until their collapse in 1911.

In the English Civil War, the Battle of Marston Moor in July 1644 saw a decisive victory for Parliament. The following summer, at Naseby in June 1645, ultimate victory was virtually guaranteed when the main army of Charles I was annihilated by Parliament's newly formed New Model Army. Led by Oliver Cromwell and Sir Thomas Fairfax, the New Model Army brought a greater professionalism and mobility into the conflict, and



Potala Palace in Tibet

The Potala Palace, seen atop the Marpo Ri hill in this view from the south, rises more than 1,000 ft (300 m) above the valley floor.

emphasized the ultimately superior resources of the Parliamentary cause.

From about 1645, the Northern Hemisphere saw crop failures brought about by abnormally cold winters. The result was famine on a massive scale, leading to both war and the collapse of state structures across the globe. These climatic changes, known since 1976 as the Maunder Minimum, were the result of reduced sunspot activity, the direct consequence of which was the Little Ice Age, in which global temperatures fell by several degrees.

In 1645, the 5th Dalai Lama, Lozang Gyatso (1617–82), began the construction of the modern Potala Palace, in Lhasa, Tibet. Construction finally ended in 1694, and it remained the seat of the Dalai Lama up to 1959.



Carisbrooke Castle, on the Isle of Wight, England, was where Charles I was imprisoned for 14 months, from 1647, after his defeat in the English Civil War.

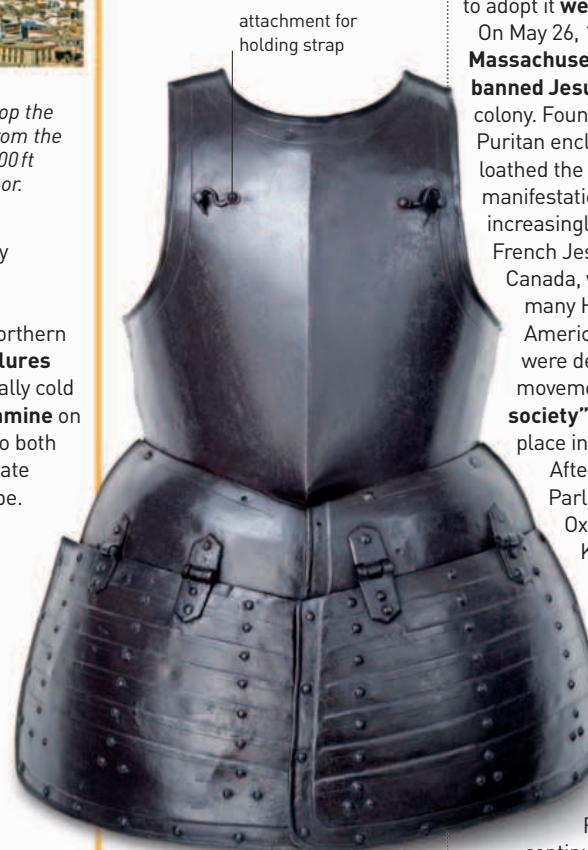
POWER IN THE EARLY YEARS OF THE QING DYNASTY was exercised by the child-emperor's uncle, Prince Dorgon (1612–50). A distinctive feature of the Qing was their hair, shaved at the front, braided into a pigtail at the back, and known as a “queue.” Dorgon

now made this compulsory for all male Han Chinese (the Queue Order). Clashing with Confucian contention that hair, as a gift from your parents, should never be cut, to wear a Manchu pigtail was seen as a mark of servility, as Dorgon intended. Thousands who refused to adopt it were put to death.

On May 26, 1647, the Massachusetts Bay Colony banned Jesuit priests from the colony. Founded as a staunchly Puritan enclave, the colonists loathed the Jesuits as a sinister manifestation of popery. Also, increasingly alarmed by the French Jesuit missionaries in Canada, who had converted many Huron and Algonquin American Indians, they were determined that a movement “subversive to society” should have no place in the new colony.

After escaping Parliament's siege of Oxford in April 1646, King Charles I surrendered to a Scottish army. The next year they delivered him to Parliament. He was imprisoned at Carisbrooke Castle, on the Isle of White.

From there, he continued to try to bargain with the various parties, but his secret negotiations with the Scottish Presbyterians to invade England led to a renewal of the English Civil War.



English Civil War armor

Metal breastplates with appended tassels (to protect the legs and lower body) were used by foot soldiers on both sides during the civil war.



GROWTH OF QING EMPIRE

Having secured control of China proper in 1644, the Qing Empire continued to expand throughout the 17th and 18th centuries, provoked in part by the threat of Russian, British, and French moves into Asia. Only some areas of the vast empire were governed directly by the Manchu or settled by the Chinese. Much was secured, at huge expense, through military garrisons.

